

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Housekeeping and Commercial Cleaning English



Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For Housekeeping attendants, commercial cleaners, custodial staff, and cleaning team members.

All room numbers, buildings, times, counts, policies, and incidents are fictional English practice, not cleaning certification, chemical-use instruction, medical advice, or access authorization. Follow employer training and site procedures for products, equipment, privacy, waste, and hazards. Do not infer permission to enter, mix products, handle unknown waste, or repair equipment. This course addresses frontline cleaning exchanges rather than hospitality management.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Confirming the assignment and its limits

Clarify the requested surfaces and the boundary of the current assignment.

02 Respecting access and occupied spaces

Agree a practical service choice with an occupant.

03 Clarifying product and task information

Describe missing product information and request qualified help.

04 Reporting faults and unsafe access

Report location, observation, and unresolved status without a technical diagnosis.

05 Handling found items and privacy questions

Give observable details and obtain a receiving acknowledgment.

06 Counting linen and replenishing supplies

State target, actual count, and difference for each item.

07 Responding to a quality concern

Clarify a quality concern and agree a check of the specific area.

08 Giving a clear end-of-shift handover

Give each area a precise status and a named follow-up.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop to choose a vocabulary, grammar, role-play, or new-dialogue activity.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Confirming the assignment and its limits

Clarify the requested surfaces and the boundary of the current assignment.

SITUATION

A commercial assignment says 'conference room: tables and floor.' The client asks for 'everything' before a 3:00 meeting. The worker is assigned table surfaces and the floor, not high windows or personal equipment. The supervisor can clarify extra work; the meeting time doesn't expand permission.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

assignment sheet - A list identifying the rooms, areas, or cleaning tasks allocated to a worker.

service scope - The specific cleaning work included in an assignment or agreement.

touchpoint - A surface or item frequently touched by people, such as a handle.

spot cleaning - Cleaning a particular marked or affected area rather than the entire surface.

Useful word combinations

confirm the assigned area: identify exactly which space belongs to the task

clarify the service scope: check which work is included

prioritize the requested room: agree which assigned space comes first

distinguish a spot from the whole surface: define the extent of a cleaning request

LESSON 01 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Turn 'everything' into named tasks

3. Notice the language

A broad request may contain extra work or items the cleaner should not move. Name the included work and ask about the rest.

My assignment includes ___, but not ___.

When you say ___, which surfaces do you mean?

I'll ask the supervisor whether ___ can be added.

Compare this wording: I'll clean everything.

Clearer: I'll clean the listed tables and floor; the additional items need a scope check.

The revised statement gives a precise commitment.

4. Check the language

1. Client: By everything, I also meant the high windows.

Cleaner: Those tasks are ___ my current assignment.

A. outside

B. included in

C. covered by

D. within

2. Supervisor: Is the client asking for the whole carpet to be cleaned?

Cleaner: No, just one marked patch. The request is for ___.

A. full carpet cleaning

B. spot cleaning

C. whole-room vacuuming

D. a general carpet inspection

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Everything has a boundary

The conference-room assignment in the case.

01 • Client: Could you clean everything in this conference room before our three o'clock meeting?

02 • Cleaner: My assignment sheet lists tables and floor. Which other items did you mean?

03 • Client: The high windows look marked, and there are laptops on some of the tables.

04 • Cleaner: Those aren't included in my task list. I can ask my supervisor about the additional request.

05 • Client: Please put the tables and floor first. The meeting can't move to another room.

06 • Cleaner: I can prioritize that assigned work, but I won't handle laptops without the site's instructions.

07 • Client: We'll ask their owners to clear them. Can you report any table area you couldn't reach?

08 • Cleaner: Yes. I'll describe any inaccessible surfaces rather than mark the whole room complete.

09 • Client: And please ask about the windows without promising they'll be finished before the meeting.

10 • Cleaner: I will. The listed table and floor work remains my assignment; the windows need review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A spot or the whole carpet?

A cleaner clarifies a client's request about a marked carpet.

01 • Cleaner: You asked me to address the carpet. Do you mean this patch or the entire room?

02 • Client: This small patch beside the door is the issue. The rest is on the usual schedule.

03 • Cleaner: Thank you. I'll report a spot-cleaning request for that patch, not a whole-room treatment.

04 • Client: Can you guarantee the mark will disappear before the visitors arrive this afternoon?

05 • Cleaner: I can't promise that outcome. I'll ask the supervisor about the suitable work and timing.

06 • Client: Please tell them it's near the entrance, where visitors will see it first.

07 • Cleaner: I'll give the exact location and note that you haven't requested the whole carpet today.

08 • Client: That's right. I want the particular mark assessed without changing the full cleaning schedule.

09 • Cleaner: Is the visitor arrival time two o'clock, as shown on the room booking?

10 • Client: Yes, two o'clock. Please use that time when you discuss the request with your supervisor.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Touchpoints in the corridor

A team member clarifies the location of a daily task.

01 • Cleaner: The sheet says corridor touchpoints. Does that include the handles inside the private offices?

02 • Team lead: Today's assignment covers shared corridor handles and railings, not entry into the private offices.

03 • Cleaner: Thanks. I wanted to check the boundary before assuming the office doors were included.

04 • Team lead: The shared-side handles are included, but office access is a separate arrangement for another shift.

05 • Cleaner: I'll describe the task as the shared corridor touchpoints, with no private-office entry.

06 • Team lead: Exactly. Please also identify which corridor section you're covering so we don't duplicate the work.

07 • Cleaner: I'll take the east corridor between the lifts and the meeting-room entrance this shift.

08 • Team lead: Then I'll assign the west corridor to Noor and leave the private-office list separate.

09 • Cleaner: If a tenant asks me to add an office, I'll refer that extra request to you.

10 • Team lead: Please do. We can clarify access and scope before changing either worker's assignment.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Confirming the assignment and its limits

A commercial assignment says 'conference room: tables and floor.' The client asks for 'everything' before a 3:00 meeting. The worker is assigned table surfaces and the floor, not high windows or personal equipment. The supervisor can clarify extra work; the meeting time doesn't expand permission.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Client: you want table surfaces and floor ready first; windows are an extra request.

Second round: The client adds laptops to 'tables.' Clarify that cleaning around personal equipment differs from handling it.

Scenario 2 | Furniture is not part of the floor request

A client asks for a meeting-room floor cleaned but heavy display units block one corner. The cleaner isn't assigned to move them. The supervisor can review access.

Role A: Cleaner: explain the inaccessible corner.

Role B: Client: arrange staff assistance or accept a recorded limitation.

Possible opening: I can reach the open floor, but that corner is blocked by the display units.

Success checks

- Name the blocked area.
- Avoid assuming permission or ability to move heavy units.
- Agree who resolves access and how completion is described.

Add a complication: The client assumes 'floor cleaning' includes moving all furniture.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Respecting access and occupied spaces

Agree a practical service choice with an occupant.

SITUATION

A guest in room 312 declines cleaning at 10:00 because of a call until 11:00. The attendant's return window is 11:15-11:30. The guest can choose a visit in that window or fresh towels at the door now. No room entry is authorized by this conversation alone.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

do-not-disturb notice - A sign communicating an occupant's request not to be disturbed; entry rules remain site-specific.

occupied room - A room currently in use by a guest or other occupant.

access window - An agreed period during which a space can be entered for assigned work.

service refusal - An occupant's decision to decline an offered cleaning visit or task.

Useful word combinations

request permission to enter: ask before entering where permission is required

agree a return time: arrange when to offer service again

respect a declined service: accept the occupant's stated choice

confirm the access window: verify when the room is available for work

LESSON 02 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Offer a return window without overriding privacy

3. Notice the language

A return appointment and permission to enter are separate. State the available window instead of promising an exact minute you can't control.

Would ___ or ___ work better?

I can return between ___ and ___.

Would you prefer no room service today?

Compare this wording: I'll come in after eleven.

Clearer: I can return between eleven fifteen and eleven thirty; would that suit you?

The guest gets a choice rather than an announced entry.

4. Check the language

1. Guest: Your return is between eleven fifteen and eleven thirty?

Attendant: Yes, that's a ____.

A. return window

B. completed visit

C. guaranteed exact minute

D. service refusal

2. Attendant: Would you prefer fresh towels ____ room cleaning today?

Guest: Yes, towels only.

A. along with

B. instead of

C. as well as

D. in addition to

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A service choice at the door

Room 312 at 10:00, following the case.

01 • Attendant: Good morning. Is now a convenient time to clean your room, or should I return?

02 • Guest: I'm on a work call until eleven, so I can't have the room cleaned now.

03 • Attendant: I can return between eleven fifteen and eleven thirty, or bring towels to the door now.

04 • Guest: Towels only would be better today. I don't need a later cleaning visit.

05 • Attendant: Certainly. How many fresh towels would you like delivered without entering the room?

06 • Guest: Two bath towels, please. I can take them at the door once you return.

07 • Attendant: I'll bring two and record that you declined room cleaning today, not all service.

08 • Guest: Thank you. Please don't interpret my declining cleaning as permission to enter after the call.

09 • Attendant: Understood. I'll leave the room entry unchanged and knock when I bring the towels.

10 • Guest: That works. I can briefly answer the door for them without interrupting the whole call.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A meeting runs beyond the access window

A cleaner negotiates access with an office occupant.

01 • Cleaner: Our access window starts at six, but I can see your meeting is still running.

02 • Office occupant: It may take another twenty minutes. Could you start cleaning around us while we finish?

03 • Cleaner: I need to check whether occupied cleaning is suitable under this site's arrangement.

04 • Office occupant: Then could you work on the corridor first and return after we leave?

05 • Cleaner: The corridor is on my assignment, so I can change that order of work.

06 • Office occupant: Thank you. We expect to leave by six twenty, but I can't guarantee that yet.

07 • Cleaner: I'll return to ask at six twenty rather than assume the room has become available.

08 • Office occupant: Please do. I'll tell the team someone will check, not announce cleaning as already started.

09 • Cleaner: If you're still here, I'll report the access delay and discuss the remaining window with my lead.

10 • Office occupant: That sounds reasonable. You can complete the corridor while we finish the meeting.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A sign and a verbal message conflict

An attendant asks the supervisor about contradictory room-access information.

01 • Attendant: Room 418 still has a do-not-disturb notice, but my sheet says service requested this morning.

02 • Supervisor: Do you have a current message from the guest resolving that difference, or only the sheet?

03 • Attendant: Only the sheet. I haven't entered or assumed the sign was left there accidentally.

04 • Supervisor: Thank you. We'll clarify the guest's current preference through the property's access arrangements.

05 • Attendant: Should I mark the room as cleaned because it appeared on the requested-service list?

06 • Supervisor: No. Mark the service as not completed due to unresolved access, using our status categories.

07 • Attendant: I'll state that the notice is present and the request on the sheet needs clarification.

08 • Supervisor: Exactly. Don't turn either piece of information into a guess about the guest's intentions.

09 • Attendant: I'll move to my next available room while you check the access question.

10 • Supervisor: Please do. I'll give you a clear update rather than leave you waiting at that door.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Respecting access and occupied spaces

A guest in room 312 declines cleaning at 10:00 because of a call until 11:00. The attendant's return window is 11:15-11:30. The guest can choose a visit in that window or fresh towels at the door now. No room entry is authorized by this conversation alone.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Guest: choose towels only today and decline a later room-cleaning visit.

Second round: The guest says 'after my call' without confirming a time. Offer the actual window again.

Scenario 2 | A locked meeting room

A cleaner has an assignment for room B at 7:00, but the door is locked and the cleaner has no approved access method. The office contact can arrange access at 7:30.

Role A: Cleaner: explain the obstacle and available work elsewhere.

Role B: Office contact: offer 7:30 access; do not ask the cleaner to improvise entry.

Possible opening: The room is locked, so that part of the assignment hasn't started.

Success checks

- Distinguish vacancy from access.
- Agree the 7:30 check.
- Keep completion status accurate.

Add a complication: The contact says the room is empty, but that doesn't supply access.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Clarifying product and task information

Describe missing product information and request qualified help.

SITUATION

A bottle on the cart has an unreadable label. A colleague identifies it by color, but two products use similar bottles. The cleaner has not used it. The supervisor can identify it and provide the relevant product information or a clearly identified replacement. No chemical steps are taught.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

product label - The information attached to a cleaning product identifying it and its stated use and warnings.

Safety Data Sheet - A document describing a chemical product's hazards and related safety information; often shortened to SDS.

cleaning - Removing dirt and other unwanted material from a surface.

disinfection - A process intended to inactivate specified microorganisms under the product's stated conditions; not synonymous with ordinary cleaning.

Useful word combinations

identify the product: confirm the exact container and product name

consult the current label: use information for the product actually present

ask for the task standard: clarify what the assignment requires

report missing information: explain which required detail cannot be confirmed

LESSON 03 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Ask for identification, not a guess

3. Notice the language

The same color or bottle shape can belong to different products. Knowing a nickname isn't the same as identifying the actual container.

The label doesn't let me confirm ____.

I haven't used ____ because ____.

Could you provide the current ____ for this product?

Compare this wording: It's the blue one, so I know it.

Clearer: The label is unreadable; color alone doesn't identify this product.

The revised explanation names the unresolved fact.

4. Check the language

1. Colleague: Both bottles are blue. Is that enough to identify this one?

Cleaner: Its identity is still ____.

A. matched to the label

B. confirmed by color

C. unverified

D. printed clearly

2. Cleaner: This Safety Data Sheet names Product A, but the bottle label names Product B.

Supervisor: Please obtain ____ for the product-information check.

A. the room's assignment sheet

B. Product A's latest SDS

C. the SDS matching Product B

D. Product B's delivery note

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The blue bottle isn't identified

The unreadable-label case at a cleaning cart.

01 • Cleaner: This bottle's label is unreadable, and two products on the cart look similar.

02 • Supervisor: Have you used the bottle, or are you asking before starting that task?

03 • Cleaner: I haven't used it. A colleague recognized the color, but couldn't confirm the contents.

04 • Supervisor: Thanks for stopping to ask. I'll arrange identification or a clearly labeled replacement.

05 • Cleaner: Could you also show me the current product label and Safety Data Sheet for the replacement?

06 • Supervisor: Yes. We'll use information matching the actual product, not a sheet for something similar.

07 • Cleaner: The room task is waiting. Should I describe the delay as a product-information problem?

08 • Supervisor: That's accurate. Don't say the product is defective; we haven't established that.

09 • Cleaner: I'll complete another assigned task that doesn't depend on this bottle while you check.

10 • Supervisor: Good. I'll tell you when the product-information issue is resolved and the task can be reassigned or resumed.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Cleaning isn't a disinfection claim

A cleaner clarifies a client's description of completed work.

01 • Client: The tables look clean. Can I tell everyone they have definitely been disinfected?

02 • Cleaner: I can confirm the cleaning task I completed, but appearance doesn't establish a disinfection claim.

03 • Client: Our meeting notice uses both words together. I assumed they meant exactly the same thing.

04 • Cleaner: They describe different tasks. My supervisor can confirm the agreed standard for this room.

05 • Client: Please ask them which work was actually included, rather than change the wording by guesswork.

06 • Cleaner: I will. The record shows table cleaning completed; it doesn't document the additional claim you're asking about.

07 • Client: Then I'll say the tables were cleaned while the other question is checked.

08 • Cleaner: That accurately describes what I can confirm from my assignment and completion record.

09 • Client: Could you have the supervisor speak to me if the agreed task needs changing?

10 • Cleaner: Yes. I'll pass on your question about the service standard, not promise a new treatment myself.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A different label on a familiar product

A cleaner notices a revised product name before starting work.

01 • Cleaner: The replacement container has a different product name from the one on our task sheet.

02 • Team lead: Is it a confirmed replacement on today's list, or just a similar-looking container?

03 • Cleaner: I don't know. The delivery person said it was the new version, but I haven't verified that.

04 • Team lead: Let's check the actual product information and whether the task sheet needs updating.

05 • Cleaner: I'll leave that task pending rather than copy instructions from the previous product.

06 • Team lead: Please identify the old and new names so the supervisor can review the difference.

07 • Cleaner: I've got both names here. The container size is the same, but that doesn't establish equivalence.

08 • Team lead: Correct. We need a confirmed match to the assigned work, not a comparison of bottle size.

09 • Cleaner: I'll ask for the correct label and Safety Data Sheet before using the replacement.

10 • Team lead: I'll arrange that check and let the client know this task hasn't been completed yet.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Clarifying product and task information

A bottle on the cart has an unreadable label. A colleague identifies it by color, but two products use similar bottles. The cleaner has not used it. The supervisor can identify it and provide the relevant product information or a clearly identified replacement. No chemical steps are taught.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Colleague: you recognize the bottle color but cannot confirm its contents.

Second round: The colleague offers a nickname. Request the exact product information from the supervisor.

Scenario 2 | A borrowed sheet names another product

A colleague offers a Safety Data Sheet whose product name differs from the container's label. The cleaner has not used the product; the supervisor can locate matching information.

Role A: Cleaner: point out the exact mismatch.

Role B: Colleague: accept that a document for a similar product isn't the same record.

Possible opening: The product name on this sheet doesn't match the bottle.

Success checks

- Compare exact product names.
- Avoid transferring instructions between products.
- Request matching current information.

Add a complication: The colleague says both products perform the same kind of cleaning.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Reporting faults and unsafe access

Report location, observation, and unresolved status without a technical diagnosis.

SITUATION

Water is visible on the floor outside washroom B, beside the east stair door. The cleaner doesn't know the source and has reported it under site arrangements. The supervisor needs an exact location and confirmation that the area has not been declared ready. No plumbing diagnosis or cleanup method is requested.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

hazard report - A report describing a condition that may cause harm and needs the appropriate response.

maintenance request - A request for the responsible team to assess or repair a building or equipment problem.

out-of-service notice - A sign identifying equipment or an area as unavailable for use.

affected area - The specific location impacted by a reported problem.

Useful word combinations

describe the observed condition: say what you saw without inventing a cause

give an exact location: identify floor, room, or nearby landmark

report a recurrence: say that the same observed condition appeared again

keep an area status clear: distinguish cleaned, restricted, and awaiting review

LESSON 04 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Give the response team useful facts

3. Notice the language

'Water near a door' is less useful than a specific washroom and landmark. Request the appropriate responder rather than offering repair steps.

I observed ___ at ___.

The source hasn't been established.

Who is handling ___, and what should I report about access?

Compare this wording: The plumbing is broken somewhere.

Clearer: Water is visible outside washroom B beside the east stair door; the source is unknown.

The report gives a checkable location without claiming a cause.

4. Check the language

1. Supervisor: Do you know where the water came from?

Cleaner: No. Its source is ____.

A. confirmed as a pipe leak

B. traced to a spill

C. unknown

D. linked to the earlier cleaning

2. Supervisor: Is the water inside washroom B?

Cleaner: No, it's ____ washroom B, beside the east stair door.

A. above

B. outside

C. opposite

D. inside

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Water beside the east stair door

The washroom B report in the case.

01 • Cleaner: There's water outside washroom B, beside the east stair door on the ground floor.

02 • Supervisor: Do you know the source, or have you only observed water in that location?

03 • Cleaner: Only the water. I haven't identified a leak or marked the affected area ready.

04 • Supervisor: I'll arrange the site's response. Have you reported the access concern through our usual contact?

05 • Cleaner: Yes, the area concern has been reported, but I need to know who takes the follow-up.

06 • Supervisor: I'll take that contact and tell the response team the exact washroom and stair-door location.

07 • Cleaner: A passerby said the floor was cleaned earlier. That doesn't explain the water now.

08 • Supervisor: Agreed. We'll use the current observation, not assume the earlier cleaning settled today's condition.

09 • Cleaner: What should the hazard report say for the incoming team?

10 • Supervisor: Tell them water was reported, the source is unknown, and I'm coordinating the response.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The noise is not a diagnosis

A cleaner reports a vacuum problem without repair instructions.

01 • Cleaner: The vacuum labeled C4 made an unfamiliar rattling sound while I was working near reception.

02 • Team lead: Have you stopped using it, and do you know whether anything specific caused the sound?

03 • Cleaner: I've stopped using it. I don't know the cause and haven't attempted a repair.

04 • Team lead: I'll arrange a check and an out-of-service notice for C4, not C14.

05 • Cleaner: The reception carpet task is incomplete. Could you confirm whether another suitable unit is available?

06 • Team lead: I'll check that. Don't report the task complete simply because most of the area was covered.

07 • Cleaner: Understood. The strip beside the visitor chairs remains unfinished, while the open aisle is complete.

08 • Team lead: That distinction helps. I'll assign the remaining strip once an equipment option is confirmed.

09 • Cleaner: Should I tell reception we need a motor replacement, as someone suggested?

10 • Team lead: No. Report the equipment check and incomplete strip; a motor diagnosis hasn't been established.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A recurring mark may need maintenance

A cleaner reports a recurring ceiling stain without identifying its cause.

01 • Cleaner: The mark above office 5's doorway is visible again after the earlier visit.

02 • Building contact: Are you saying there's a confirmed leak, or just that the mark has returned?

03 • Cleaner: Just that it has returned. I haven't established the source or a repair requirement.

04 • Building contact: I'll pass that observation to maintenance. When did you notice the change today?

05 • Cleaner: At about seven this morning, while completing the corridor assignment outside office five.

06 • Building contact: Is the office itself affected, or did you only observe the corridor-facing area?

07 • Cleaner: I observed the area above the doorway from the corridor. I haven't inspected inside.

08 • Building contact: Then I'll keep the request limited to that location and ask maintenance to assess it.

09 • Cleaner: Please tell me who receives the maintenance request so I can hand over the status accurately.

10 • Building contact: I've accepted it for the building team. Tell the next cleaner assessment is pending with me.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Reporting faults and unsafe access

Water is visible on the floor outside washroom B, beside the east stair door. The cleaner doesn't know the source and has reported it under site arrangements. The supervisor needs an exact location and confirmation that the area has not been declared ready. No plumbing diagnosis or cleanup method is requested.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Supervisor: ask for the precise location and accept the response-team contact.

Second round: A passerby says the floor was cleaned earlier. Explain why the present water still needs reporting.

Scenario 2 | A notice belongs to another machine

Two floor machines stand together. One has an out-of-service notice identifying unit F3. The second is F8. The cleaner hasn't checked F8's readiness.

Role A: Cleaner: report F3's notice without assuming F8 is ready.

Role B: Lead: confirm the exact equipment identifiers and arrange the separate readiness check.

Possible opening: The notice names F3; I haven't confirmed F8's status.

Success checks

- Identify F3 correctly.
- Keep F8's readiness separate.
- Request confirmation instead of inferring it from appearance.

Add a complication: A colleague treats absence of a notice as proof of readiness.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Handling found items and privacy questions

Give observable details and obtain a receiving acknowledgment.

SITUATION

An attendant finds a closed black glasses case beneath the chair in room 214 after checkout. The owner is unknown. The attendant should report visible details without opening it and transfer it to the designated lost-property receiver, who can confirm receipt. Don't identify an owner from a guess.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

lost property - Items found without their owner present and handled through the site's return arrangements.

item description - A factual account of a found object's visible identifying features.

found location - The precise place where an item was discovered, separate from where it is later stored.

custody record - A record identifying who received or held an item during its transfer.

Useful word combinations

report a found item: notify the responsible person of an unattended object

describe visible features: state what can be observed without searching private contents

record the found location: preserve where the object was discovered

confirm receipt of the item: verify who accepted the transfer

LESSON 05 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Transfer an item without inventing its owner

3. Notice the language

Finding an item in a room doesn't prove who owns it. Describe the exterior and location without inspecting private contents or publicly disclosing guest information.

I found a ___ at ___.

The owner is not confirmed.

Can you confirm you've received ___?

Compare this wording: It's the last guest's glasses.

Clearer: It's a closed black glasses case; the owner is unconfirmed.

The description separates observation from an ownership guess.

4. Check the language

1. Receiver: Where was the case found?

Attendant: ___ the chair in room 214.

A. Under

B. On top of

C. Beside

D. Inside

2. Attendant: Have you accepted the item?

Receiver: Yes, ___.

A. I can describe where it was found

B. I've received the closed black case

C. I was told about it

D. I'll receive it after lunch

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A case under the chair

The room 214 lost-property handover.

01 • Attendant: I found a closed black glasses case beneath the chair in room two-fourteen after checkout.

02 • Lost-property receiver: Have you opened it or identified the owner from anything visible on the outside?

03 • Attendant: I haven't opened it. My item description is based only on the outside.

04 • Lost-property receiver: I'll receive it through our lost-property arrangement. Please confirm the found location again.

05 • Attendant: Beneath the chair in two-fourteen, not on the desk or in the corridor.

06 • Lost-property receiver: I've received the closed black case; the custody record will show that found location.

07 • Attendant: A colleague assumed it belonged to the last guest, but that hasn't been confirmed.

08 • Lost-property receiver: We'll keep ownership unconfirmed. Any claimant can speak with the designated team about identification.

09 • Attendant: Do you need anything else from me to complete this transfer record?

10 • Lost-property receiver: Only your confirmation of the observation; I've accepted the item and the follow-up from here.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Papers beside a bin aren't necessarily waste

A commercial cleaner asks about loose documents.

01 • Cleaner: There are loose papers beside the recycling bin, but they aren't inside it.

02 • Office contact: Have they been marked for disposal, or are you asking because their status is unclear?

03 • Cleaner: Their status is unclear. I haven't read the contents or treated them as waste.

04 • Office contact: Thank you. Those belong to the meeting organizer, who left them for collection.

05 • Cleaner: I'll leave them in place and clean the accessible area around them.

06 • Office contact: Please do. The organizer will move them before your next scheduled visit.

07 • Cleaner: Should I record that this small floor area couldn't be completed because documents blocked access?

08 • Office contact: Yes, describe the blocked area without including any information from the papers themselves.

09 • Cleaner: I'll say the floor beside the recycling bin remains inaccessible due to stored documents.

10 • Office contact: That is enough. I'll arrange their removal without asking you to decide what can be discarded.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A visitor asks for someone else's property

A cleaner redirects an ownership claim to the designated team.

01 • Visitor: I heard you found a phone in the lounge. Can you give it to me?

02 • Cleaner: The lost-property team handles return requests. I can direct you to their desk.

03 • Visitor: It's probably my colleague's phone. They asked me to collect anything you found.

04 • Cleaner: I can't confirm ownership or release an item from that statement alone.

05 • Visitor: Could you at least tell me whose name appears on the screen?

06 • Cleaner: I haven't inspected private information. Please explain your request to the lost-property team.

07 • Visitor: Where is the desk, and will they know about the item from the lounge?

08 • Cleaner: The reception desk handles these inquiries and can check the relevant record.

09 • Visitor: I'll go there and provide the details they request to assess the claim.

10 • Cleaner: Thank you. They can discuss the return arrangement; I don't need your colleague's personal details here.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Handling found items and privacy questions

An attendant finds a closed black glasses case beneath the chair in room 214 after checkout. The owner is unknown. The attendant should report visible details without opening it and transfer it to the designated lost-property receiver, who can confirm receipt. Don't identify an owner from a guess.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Receiver: accept the closed case and repeat the found location; ownership remains unknown.

Second round: A colleague asks you to name the previous guest in a public area. Keep the inquiry with the designated receiver.

Scenario 2 | Found location versus storage location

A cleaner found a scarf on the third-floor lounge sofa. It is now held by the designated office on the ground floor. A colleague asks where it was found.

Role A: Cleaner: distinguish discovery and current custody.

Role B: Colleague: repeat both locations accurately.

Possible opening: It was found upstairs, but the ground-floor office now holds it.

Success checks

- Name the lounge sofa as the found location.
- Name the office as current custody.
- Correct the record without adding ownership assumptions.

Add a complication: The colleague starts recording the ground-floor office as the found location.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Counting linen and replenishing supplies

State target, actual count, and difference for each item.

SITUATION

The third-floor cart target is twelve bath towels and eight hand towels. The attendant counts nine bath towels and eight hand towels. A laundry delivery is expected but not confirmed. Report the three-bath-towel shortfall without calling all linen unavailable.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

linen - Fabric items used in rooms or service areas, such as sheets and towels.

replenishment - Adding supplies to replace what has been used or is missing.

par stock - The target quantity of a supply used as a stocking reference.

discrepancy - A difference between a recorded quantity and the quantity actually counted.

Useful word combinations

count by item type: keep different supplies in separate totals

replenish the dispenser: restore the assigned supply without assuming a different product fits

report the shortfall: state how many items are missing from the target

confirm an allocation: identify supplies assigned to a particular floor or task

LESSON 06 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Give useful counts, not a general shortage

3. Notice the language

Separate item types and distinguish an expected delivery from available stock. A shortfall in one item doesn't mean every linen item is unavailable.

We have ___ against a target of ___.

We're short ___ of ___; ___ is complete.

The delivery is expected, but ___.

Compare this wording: We're out of linen.

Clearer: We're three bath towels short; all eight hand towels are present.

The next person knows exactly what needs replenishment.

4. Check the language

1. Lead: Twelve bath towels are needed and nine are on the cart.

Attendant: The shortfall is ____.

- A. three hand towels
- B. twelve hand towels
- C. three bath towels
- D. nine bath towels

2. Lead: Has laundry confirmed when the delivery will arrive?

Attendant: No. It is ____.

- A. expected this afternoon, but unconfirmed
- B. confirmed for this afternoon
- C. canceled for this afternoon
- D. already delivered

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Only the bath towels are short

The third-floor cart count from the case.

01 • Attendant: I've counted nine bath towels and eight hand towels on the third-floor cart.

02 • Linen colleague: Our par stock is twelve bath towels and eight hand towels. What's the shortfall?

03 • Attendant: Three bath towels. The hand-towel count is complete, and I haven't reported a general linen stockout.

04 • Linen colleague: A laundry delivery is expected this afternoon, but I don't have a confirmed arrival time.

05 • Attendant: Could you check whether three bath towels can be allocated from stock already available?

06 • Linen colleague: I'll check that now. Are the nine on your cart all assigned to this floor?

07 • Attendant: Yes, none are reserved for another floor or already promised for a separate request.

08 • Linen colleague: Then I'll look for the three-item shortfall rather than send you another full cart allocation.

09 • Attendant: Thank you. Please tell me if the request is accepted or still waiting on delivery.

10 • Linen colleague: I found three available bath towels and can allocate them now; laundry timing remains separate.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A carton count hides the refill type

A cleaner checks supplies delivered to an office washroom.

01 • Cleaner: Two cartons arrived, but only one has the paper-towel refill type listed for our washroom.

02 • Stores colleague: What's in the other carton? Does its label identify a different dispenser refill?

03 • Cleaner: Yes, it is labeled for the larger dispenser used on the ground floor.

04 • Stores colleague: Then two cartons delivered doesn't mean two suitable cartons for your assigned washroom.

05 • Cleaner: Exactly. I can report one correct carton and one allocation that needs checking.

06 • Stores colleague: I'll review the delivery destination rather than ask you to make the wrong refill fit.

07 • Cleaner: The upper-floor dispensers still need the listed type. Can you check available stock?

08 • Stores colleague: Yes. I'll confirm the correct product code and the number available before promising replenishment.

09 • Cleaner: I'll keep the upper-floor shortage separate from the total number of cartons received.

10 • Stores colleague: That will make the request clear and prevent another delivery of the wrong refill type.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

An allocation isn't extra stock

A room attendant checks whether linen in another cart is available.

01 • Attendant: The neighboring cart has six spare-looking sheets. Can I take two for my assignment?

02 • Team lead: They may already be allocated. Which room tasks are you short on right now?

03 • Attendant: I'm short two sheets against my current assignment, and my own cart has none remaining.

04 • Team lead: Thanks. I'll check that cart's allocation before assuming its visible supplies are spare.

05 • Attendant: I don't want to leave the next attendant short just because their cart looks full.

06 • Team lead: Exactly. The count is six, but the room list shows all six assigned to their floor.

07 • Attendant: Then I need another source for my two, rather than reclassify those sheets as unassigned.

08 • Team lead: I'll check the linen room for available stock and tell you the confirmed amount.

09 • Attendant: Please also confirm whether that changes my room sequence while we wait for supplies.

10 • Team lead: Yes. You can take the supply-independent tasks first; we'll keep the two-sheet shortfall visible.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Counting linen and replenishing supplies

The third-floor cart target is twelve bath towels and eight hand towels. The attendant counts nine bath towels and eight hand towels. A laundry delivery is expected but not confirmed. Report the three-bath-towel shortfall without calling all linen unavailable.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Lead: you can check storage, but cannot promise the laundry arrival time.

Second round: Another floor requests two towels from this cart. Explain the effect on its count before any reassignment.

Scenario 2 | A changed room allocation changes the target

An attendant's cart has ten bath towels for a ten-towel assignment. The supervisor adds two rooms requiring four more bath towels under the fictional plan. No extra towels have arrived.

Role A: Attendant: state the revised target and shortfall.

Role B: Supervisor: confirm fourteen total and arrange four additional towels.

Possible opening: Does the added assignment raise my bath-towel target from ten to fourteen?

Success checks

- Confirm fourteen as the new target.
- Report four additional towels needed.
- Keep assignment change separate from delivered stock.

Add a complication: A colleague counts the original ten as though the new rooms were already covered.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Responding to a quality concern

Clarify a quality concern and agree a check of the specific area.

SITUATION

A client reports streaks on the interior glass panel beside office 8, cleaned earlier that day. The cleaner can acknowledge the reported result and ask the lead to arrange a check and appropriate rework. The cause is unknown; the client is available to point out the panel.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

inspection - A check of completed work against the relevant task requirements.

rework - Work repeated or corrected because the first result didn't meet the specified requirement.

residue - Material left on a surface after use or a cleaning task.

streak - A visible line or uneven mark on a surface such as glass.

Useful word combinations

acknowledge the specific concern: name the mark or missed area the person reports

ask for the exact location: identify which surface needs attention

check against the task requirement: compare the result with the assigned standard

confirm the correction: ask whether the reported issue has been addressed

LESSON 07 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Address the result without arguing about effort

3. Notice the language

'It was cleaned' doesn't mean every result meets the task requirement. Listen for the exact surface and defect instead of defending how long the task took.

Could you show me the exact ___?

I can see the ___ you mean.

I'll ask for a check of ___, not assume ___.

Compare this wording: We already did that.

Clearer: That panel was cleaned earlier; I can see the streaks you're pointing out.

The revision acknowledges both earlier work and the present concern.

4. Check the language

1. Client: I mean visible wipe-like lines across the glass, not a coating, grooves, or missing pieces.

Cleaner: So you're describing ___.

A. chips

B. residue

C. scratches

D. streaks

2. Cleaner: I'll report what I can see, ___ guess the cause.

Client: Thank you.

A. because of

B. rather than

C. as well as

D. in addition to

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The panel beside office eight

The glass-quality concern in the case.

- 01 • Client:** There are streaks on the glass you cleaned earlier beside office eight.
- 02 • Cleaner:** Thank you for pointing them out. Is it this interior panel or the outside surface?
- 03 • Client:** This interior panel, especially the upper corner. I'm not referring to the other windows.
- 04 • Cleaner:** I can see the marks you mean. I'll ask our lead to inspect this specific panel.
- 05 • Client:** Can you tell me why they appeared? Was the wrong product used on it?
- 06 • Cleaner:** I don't know the cause. I'll report the visible streaks without guessing about the product.
- 07 • Client:** That's fair. I mainly want the result checked and corrected if it needs rework.
- 08 • Cleaner:** I'll arrange that request through the lead and ask when the panel can be revisited.
- 09 • Client:** Please keep me informed, because the room is free only until the afternoon meeting.
- 10 • Cleaner:** I'll pass on that access limit with the panel location, so the timing can be discussed.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The reported residue is on another desk

A cleaner checks the precise location of a complaint.

01 • Cleaner: You reported residue on a desk. Could you show me which desk you mean?

02 • Office occupant: The one beside the printer, not the reception desk your colleague looked at.

03 • Cleaner: Thank you. That distinction matters because the two desks have different assignment entries.

04 • Office occupant: I'm not saying the whole office was missed. This is the specific surface I'm concerned about.

05 • Cleaner: I'll report this desk and the visible residue, rather than widen the complaint to the entire office.

06 • Office occupant: Can you deal with it while the papers stay spread across the work surface?

07 • Cleaner: I need the agreed access arrangements. Could the owner clear the affected area first?

08 • Office occupant: I'll ask them now. Please don't move or read the papers to find the mark.

09 • Cleaner: I won't. Once access is available, the lead can confirm the appropriate corrective task.

10 • Office occupant: Good. I'll tell you when the surface is clear so that inspection can take place.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Checking the correction with the occupant

A cleaner returns after the assigned rework has been completed.

01 • Cleaner: The lead arranged rework on the marked panel. Could you check the area you identified earlier?

02 • Occupant: Yes, this is the corner I meant. The streaks I reported are no longer visible.

03 • Cleaner: Thank you. Does that resolve your original concern about this panel's appearance?

04 • Occupant: It does. I also noticed a separate mark on the door handle, though.

05 • Cleaner: I'll treat that as a new specific concern, not assume the panel correction failed.

06 • Occupant: That's right. The glass issue is resolved; the handle wasn't part of what I showed you.

07 • Cleaner: Could you point to the handle and describe the visible mark for the next request?

08 • Occupant: It's the meeting-room handle, with a small sticky-looking patch near its base.

09 • Cleaner: I'll report that observation to the lead without claiming what the material is.

10 • Occupant: Thank you. Please close the glass concern and keep the handle request separate.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Responding to a quality concern

A client reports streaks on the interior glass panel beside office 8, cleaned earlier that day. The cleaner can acknowledge the reported result and ask the lead to arrange a check and appropriate rework. The cause is unknown; the client is available to point out the panel.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Client: point to the inside panel beside office 8 and ask when someone can check it.

Second round: The client says all windows must be poor. Keep the confirmed concern limited to the identified panel.

Scenario 2 | A complaint names the wrong floor

A client says the second-floor mirror is streaked, then points to a photograph labeled third floor. The cleaner hasn't inspected either mirror.

Role A: Cleaner: clarify which location the photograph shows.

Role B: Client: confirm third floor and withdraw the second-floor location.

Possible opening: Before I request rework, which mirror does this photograph identify?

Success checks

- Confirm third floor.
- Avoid reporting both mirrors as defective.
- Request inspection of the identified surface.

Add a complication: The client says the mirrors look identical.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Giving a clear end-of-shift handover

Give each area a precise status and a named follow-up.

SITUATION

Rooms 301 and 302 have been cleaned; 302 awaits the supervisor's inspection. Room 303 was inaccessible and not cleaned. The incoming attendant can accept 303's access follow-up, while the supervisor owns 302's inspection. Report each status separately without deciding room release.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

room status - The recorded stage of a room's service, such as not started, in progress, or awaiting inspection.

outstanding task - Work that has not yet been completed.

completion record - A record showing which assigned work was actually completed and any relevant limitations.

sign-off - A recorded confirmation by the designated person that a specified check or task meets its requirement.

Useful word combinations

hand over the remaining area: identify unfinished work and its next owner

distinguish cleaned from inspected: keep task completion separate from a later check

record an access limitation: state what prevented work in a particular area

confirm who takes over: obtain acknowledgment from the receiving worker

LESSON 08 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Report the stage, not a vague 'ready'

3. Notice the language

Cleaned, inspected, and released can be separate statuses under a site's arrangements. Do not turn a completed cleaning task into a broader authorization.

___ is cleaned but awaits ___.

___ hasn't started because ___.

Can you accept the follow-up for ___?

Compare this wording: The third floor is ready.

Clearer: 301 is cleaned; 302 awaits inspection; 303 remains uncleaned due to access.

The statuses let the next worker act without guessing.

4. Check the language

1. Incoming attendant: Is 302's inspection complete?

Outgoing attendant: It's cleaned, but inspection is ____.

A. already signed off

B. no longer required

C. scheduled and completed

D. still pending

2. Outgoing attendant: Can you take 303's access follow-up?

Incoming attendant: Yes, ____.

A. I sent someone a note about access

B. I remember seeing the access request

C. I thought it belonged to the earlier shift

D. I'll confirm access and update its status

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Three rooms, three statuses

The end-of-shift case on the third floor.

01 • Outgoing attendant: Room three-oh-one is cleaned. Three-oh-two is cleaned too, but it still awaits the supervisor's inspection.

02 • Incoming attendant: What about three-oh-three? Its room status doesn't show a completed cleaning task.

03 • Outgoing attendant: It was inaccessible, so cleaning hasn't started. Can you take its access follow-up?

04 • Incoming attendant: Yes, I'll check access for three-oh-three and update its status once I know more.

05 • Outgoing attendant: Thank you. I'll confirm the inspection request for three-oh-two with the supervisor before leaving.

06 • Incoming attendant: Then I'm not being asked to release three-oh-two or describe its inspection as complete?

07 • Outgoing attendant: Correct. The supervisor's sign-off is separate. Please focus on checking access to three-oh-three.

08 • Incoming attendant: I'll repeat the status: three-oh-one cleaned; three-oh-two awaiting inspection; three-oh-three uncleaned because access was unavailable.

09 • Outgoing attendant: That's the current picture. Please report any change rather than carry yesterday's assumptions forward.

10 • Incoming attendant: I will. I'll start by contacting the person responsible for access to three-oh-three.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A completed area has one limitation

A commercial cleaner gives a precise end-of-shift report.

01 • Cleaner: The west office floor is complete except the space beneath the blocked storage shelf.

02 • Incoming colleague: Was that space inaccessible throughout the visit, or did you leave it for another reason?

03 • Cleaner: It was blocked by stored boxes. I wasn't assigned to move them.

04 • Incoming colleague: Then I'll keep that limitation in the completion record rather than mark every area finished.

05 • Cleaner: The office contact has agreed to arrange clearance before tomorrow's visit, but it hasn't happened yet.

06 • Incoming colleague: I'll check whether the boxes are moved before reporting that the remaining area can be reached.

07 • Cleaner: Everything else on that floor's list is complete, including bins and the shared table surfaces.

08 • Incoming colleague: Thanks. Is the blocked area the only outstanding task I'm inheriting for that office?

09 • Cleaner: Yes. The separate maintenance request for the corridor light belongs to the building team.

10 • Incoming colleague: I'll keep the floor limitation and the maintenance request separate in my handover update.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The receiver cannot take the task

An outgoing cleaner finds that the intended colleague is assigned elsewhere.

01 • Outgoing cleaner: Could you take the final washroom supply check? It hasn't been completed on my shift.

02 • Colleague: I can't accept it yet; I'm assigned to another building for the rest of tonight.

03 • Outgoing cleaner: Thanks for saying so. I won't mark it handed over just because we've discussed it.

04 • Colleague: Please ask the supervisor to reassign it. They know who is staying at this site.

05 • Outgoing cleaner: I'll keep it listed as outstanding and contact them before I finish my report.

06 • Colleague: Tell them the exact washroom and which check is missing so they can allocate it.

07 • Outgoing cleaner: It's washroom C's paper-towel replenishment check, not a new full-room cleaning request.

08 • Colleague: That distinction should help them choose the appropriate worker and avoid duplicating completed cleaning.

09 • Outgoing cleaner: The supervisor has accepted the reassignment question. I'll record that, with the check still unfinished.

10 • Colleague: Good. Someone has the allocation follow-up now, but the supply check itself remains outstanding.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Giving a clear end-of-shift handover

Rooms 301 and 302 have been cleaned; 302 awaits the supervisor's inspection. Room 303 was inaccessible and not cleaned. The incoming attendant can accept 303's access follow-up, while the supervisor owns 302's inspection. Report each status separately without deciding room release.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Incoming attendant: accept 303's access question and repeat that its cleaning hasn't started.

Second round: A caller asks whether 302 can be released. Direct the release question to the responsible person.

Scenario 2 | A room number is read incorrectly

The outgoing attendant says room 416 awaits inspection. The incoming worker repeats 460. Room 460 is on another floor and isn't in this handover.

Role A: Outgoing attendant: correct the exact room number.

Role B: Incoming attendant: read back 416 and its pending inspection.

Possible opening: I said four-one-six, not four-six-zero.

Success checks

- Repeat digits distinctly.
- Confirm 416.
- Preserve awaiting-inspection status without changing 460.

Add a complication: A noisy corridor makes the final digits hard to hear.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Confirming the assignment and its limits

Editing example: I'll clean the listed tables and floor; the additional items need a scope check.

The revised statement gives a precise commitment.

Check 1: A - outside

A: Correct. The current assignment covers tables and floor, not high windows.

B: 'Included in' would incorrectly claim the extra work was assigned.

C: 'Covered by' would also include work outside the stated scope.

D: 'Within' would put those extra tasks inside the listed scope.

Check 2: B - spot cleaning

A: Full carpet cleaning extends beyond the patch the client identified.

B: Correct. Spot cleaning targets the particular marked area.

C: This covers the whole room rather than the one patch.

D: Inspection assesses the carpet; the request specifically asks for cleaning.

Model response: The assignment covers the conference-room table surfaces and floor. When you say everything, are you also asking about the high windows and personal equipment? Those aren't included in my current task list. I can complete the listed work and ask my supervisor to review the additional request before anyone promises it for three o'clock.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Respecting access and occupied spaces

Editing example: I can return between eleven fifteen and eleven thirty; would that suit you?

The guest gets a choice rather than an announced entry.

Check 1: A - return window

A: Correct. A window gives a range of times.

B: The visit has not yet taken place.

C: A fifteen-minute interval is not one guaranteed minute.

D: The guest is checking an offered visit, not refusing it.

Check 2: B - instead of

A: This keeps both services rather than towels alone.

B: Correct. The guest chooses towels as the replacement service.

C: This would request both services, unlike 'towels only'.

D: This adds cleaning rather than replacing it.

Model response: I understand you're on a call until eleven. I can offer a return between eleven fifteen and eleven thirty, or bring fresh towels to the door now if that is all you need. Which would you prefer? I'll record your choice, and we'll still follow the room-access arrangements when I return.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Clarifying product and task information

Editing example: The label is unreadable; color alone doesn't identify this product.

The revised explanation names the unresolved fact.

Check 1: C - unverified

A: No readable label match has been obtained.

B: The case gives two products with similar color.

C: Correct. Appearance hasn't established the actual product identity.

D: The label is explicitly described as unreadable.

Check 2: C - the SDS matching Product B

A: The room assignment identifies work, not the product's hazard information.

B: A newer document for Product A still doesn't match Product B.

C: Correct. The Safety Data Sheet must identify the actual product being checked.

D: A matching delivery note doesn't replace the product's Safety Data Sheet.

Model response: I can't identify this bottle from its unreadable label, and its color doesn't resolve which product it contains. I haven't used it. Could you help confirm the product and its current information, or provide a clearly identified replacement? I need that resolved before I continue the assigned task with this bottle.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Reporting faults and unsafe access

Editing example: Water is visible outside washroom B beside the east stair door; the source is unknown.

The report gives a checkable location without claiming a cause.

Check 1: C - unknown

A: No pipe fault has been established from the observation.

B: No spill has been confirmed as the water's source.

C: Correct. The cleaner observed water without establishing its cause.

D: Earlier cleaning doesn't establish the cause of the present water.

Check 2: B - outside

A: No water above the washroom has been reported.

B: Correct. Outside locates the water beyond the washroom entrance.

C: Opposite means across from it, which the case doesn't establish.

D: Inside contradicts the cleaner's correction and the stated location.

Model response: There is water on the floor outside washroom B, beside the east stair door. I don't know its source, and I haven't marked that area ready. Please arrange the appropriate site response and tell me who is taking the follow-up. I'll report the location and current restriction clearly to the next team.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Handling found items and privacy questions

Editing example: It's a closed black glasses case; the owner is unconfirmed.

The description separates observation from an ownership guess.

Check 1: A - Under

A: Correct. 'Under' matches the stated location beneath the chair.

B: The case wasn't found on top of it.

C: Beside means next to, not beneath, the chair.

D: The case wasn't found inside the chair.

Check 2: B - I've received the closed black case

A: Knowing the found location doesn't acknowledge accepting custody.

B: Correct. This names the item and confirms completed receipt.

C: Being told about an item doesn't confirm its receipt.

D: A future intention doesn't confirm acceptance has happened now.

Model response: I found a closed black glasses case beneath the chair in room two-fourteen. I haven't opened it, and I don't know whose it is. Could you receive it through the lost-property arrangement and confirm the transfer? Please keep the found location separate from its storage location so any later inquiry uses the correct details.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Counting linen and replenishing supplies

Editing example: We're three bath towels short; all eight hand towels are present.

The next person knows exactly what needs replenishment.

Check 1: C - three bath towels

A: The hand-towel count is already complete.

B: This uses the wrong item and quantity.

C: Correct. Twelve minus nine leaves three bath towels.

D: Nine is the amount present, not the missing amount.

Check 2: A - expected this afternoon, but unconfirmed

A: Correct. This preserves the expected timing without claiming verification.

B: This conflicts with the explicit absence of confirmation.

C: An unconfirmed time doesn't mean the delivery was canceled.

D: No completed arrival has been reported in the scenario.

Model response: The cart has nine bath towels and eight hand towels. Against today's target of twelve and eight, we're short three bath towels; the hand-towel count is complete. A laundry delivery is expected, but its arrival isn't confirmed. Could you check whether three bath towels can be allocated from available stock?

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Responding to a quality concern

Editing example: That panel was cleaned earlier; I can see the streaks you're pointing out.

The revision acknowledges both earlier work and the present concern.

Check 1: D - streaks

A: Chips involve missing pieces of material, which the client excludes.

B: Residue names material left behind, not the specific line pattern described.

C: Scratches are surface damage such as grooves, which the client excludes.

D: Correct. Streaks are the visible lines or uneven wipe marks described.

Check 2: B - rather than

A: 'Because of' needs a noun phrase, not this verb form.

B: Correct. This contrasts observation with an unsupported explanation.

C: This would add guessing to the reported observation.

D: This also adds guessing and requires a different verb form.

Model response: Thank you for showing me the streaks on the interior panel beside office eight. That is the panel on today's completed task list. I'm sorry the result needs attention. I'll ask our lead to check it and arrange the appropriate rework. I don't know the cause yet, so I'll report the visible marks rather than guess.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Giving a clear end-of-shift handover

Editing example: 301 is cleaned; 302 awaits inspection; 303 remains uncleaned due to access.

The statuses let the next worker act without guessing.

Check 1: D - still pending

A: No inspection sign-off has been confirmed in the case.

B: The required check remains open despite completed cleaning.

C: Scheduling a check doesn't establish that it was completed.

D: Correct. The inspection remains unfinished despite completed cleaning.

Check 2: D - I'll confirm access and update its status

A: Sending a note doesn't identify who now accepts the task.

B: Remembering a request doesn't commit to carrying it out.

C: This states a previous assumption rather than accepting responsibility.

D: Correct. This explicitly accepts the named follow-up and reporting task.

Model response: Room three-oh-one is cleaned. Three-oh-two is also cleaned, but the supervisor's inspection is still pending. Three-oh-three was inaccessible and hasn't been cleaned. Can you take the access follow-up for three-oh-three? I'll confirm the inspection request with the supervisor; please don't describe that pending check as a completed sign-off or a room-release decision.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and switches roles and repeats the exchange. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All room numbers, buildings, times, counts, policies, and incidents are fictional English practice, not cleaning certification, chemical-use instruction, medical advice, or access authorization. Follow employer training and site procedures for products, equipment, privacy, waste, and hazards. Do not infer permission to enter, mix products, handle unknown waste, or repair equipment. This course addresses frontline cleaning exchanges rather than hospitality management.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook: Janitors and Building Cleaners

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/building-and-grounds-cleaning/janitors-and-building-cleaners.htm>

O*NET OnLine: Maids and Housekeeping Cleaners

<https://www.onetonline.org/link/summary/37-2012.00>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Practice grammar in context

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Housekeeping and Commercial Cleaning English

Professional audience: Housekeeping attendants, commercial cleaners, custodial staff, and cleaning team members

Scope: All room numbers, buildings, times, counts, policies, and incidents are fictional English practice, not cleaning certification, chemical-use instruction, medical advice, or access authorization. Follow employer training and site procedures for products, equipment, privacy, waste, and hazards. Do not infer permission to enter, mix products, handle unknown waste, or repair equipment. This course addresses frontline cleaning exchanges rather than hospitality management.

Lesson 01: Confirming the assignment and its limits

Original fictional case: A commercial assignment says 'conference room: tables and floor.' The client asks for 'everything' before a 3:00 meeting. The worker is assigned table surfaces and the floor, not high windows or personal equipment. The supervisor can clarify extra work; the meeting time doesn't expand permission.

Language workshop: Turn 'everything' into named tasks

Communication goal: Clarify the requested surfaces and the boundary of the current assignment.

Language guidance: A broad request may contain extra work or items the cleaner should not move. Name the included work and ask about the rest.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): My assignment includes ___, but not ___. / When you say ___, which surfaces do you mean? / I'll ask the supervisor whether ___ can be added.

Vocabulary: assignment sheet: A list identifying the rooms, areas, or cleaning tasks allocated to a worker. / service scope: The specific cleaning work included in an assignment or agreement. / touchpoint: A surface or item frequently touched by people, such as a handle. / spot cleaning: Cleaning a particular marked or affected area rather than the entire surface.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Client: you want table surfaces and floor ready first; windows are an extra request.

Guided response task: Complete a workplace dialogue by selecting one of four supplied options. Compare the feedback and say the completed exchange aloud. Do not write an open-ended message.

Optional second-round challenge: The client adds laptops to 'tables.' Clarify that cleaning around personal equipment differs from handling it.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: The assignment covers the conference-room table surfaces and floor. When you say everything, are you also asking about the high windows and personal equipment? Those aren't included in my current task list. I can complete the listed work and ask my supervisor to review the additional request before anyone promises it for three o'clock.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Choose grammar that preserves the meaning

1. Use the lesson's language workshop, or one actual sentence from the dialogue, to explain a single grammar distinction in no more than 90 words. Show how it affects timing, certainty, responsibility or politeness.
2. Give one brief occupational exchange containing a gap and four complete options A-D. Supply enough context for exactly one answer. Keep distractors plausible; distinguish grammar errors from wording that changes the facts. Stop and wait.
3. Explain why each choice fits or fails, then ask me to read the completed exchange aloud. Do not request a draft, original written sentence or essay.
4. Repeat with three new exchanges, one at a time, moving from recognition to a more subtle meaning contrast. Do not copy the published checks. Label invented variations and do not turn uncertainty into a promise.
5. End with a short contrast table and two supported spoken turns using supplied frames. Accept accurate alternatives in oral practice; acknowledge and replace ambiguous multiple-choice items.

END PROMPT